

RECIPES > DRINKS RECIPES > HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Creamy Homemade Hot Cocoa

★★★★☆ 4.7 (1,519) | [1,179 REVIEWS](#) | [111 PHOTOS](#)

This cozy hot chocolate is so comforting on a dreary day. It makes the kitchen smell wonderful and it's good for the soul.

Submitted by [Jeanie Bean](#) | Updated on February 6, 2026

Tested by [Allrecipes Test Kitchen](#)

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Prep Time:

5 mins

Cook Time:

5 mins

Total Time:

10 mins

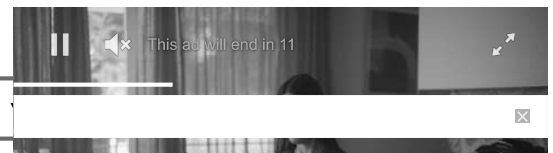
Servings:

4

[Jump to Nutrition Facts](#)

JUMP TO RECIPE

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homemade treat to warm you up.

Hot Chocolate Ingredients

These are the simple ingredients you'll need to make the best hot chocolate of your entire life:

Sugar and cocoa powder: This sweet and creamy hot cocoa starts with white sugar and unsweetened cocoa powder.

Salt: A pinch of salt enhances the chocolatey flavor, but it won't make your hot cocoa taste salty.

Water: Pour boiling water over the sugar, cocoa powder, and salt.

Milk: You can use whole, 2 percent, or the alternative milk of your choice.

Vanilla: A dash of vanilla takes the decadent flavor over the top.

Half-and-half: Half-and-half is added after the hot chocolate is poured into the mugs, creating a rich texture and cooling the cocoa to a drinkable temperature.

Does Hot Chocolate Have Caffeine?

Hot chocolate contains a small amount of caffeine because chocolate is slightly caffeinated. However, it has much less caffeine than coffee, sodas, and many teas. Unless you are very sensitive to caffeine, hot cocoa is unlikely to keep you up at night.

How to Serve Hot Chocolate

This creamy hot chocolate is decadent enough to sip as-is. You can take it up a notch with traditional toppings like [marshmallows](#), homemade whipped cream, or a drizzle of [chocolate sauce](#). For a festive twist and subtle minty flavor, garnish each mug of hot cocoa with a candy cane. Adults may appreciate a shot of Irish cream, amaretto, or peppermint vodka.

Allrecipes Community Tips and Prai

"The perfect amount of richness and it would be so easy to more people," according to [Danielle K.](#) "I topped mine with chocolate shavings. My kids love marshmallows. Make it yo

"Most AMAZING hot cocoa I've ever had," raves [Becky.](#) "I sul half with a shot of Irish Cream."

⏏ 🔊 This ad will end in 11



☐ Keep Screen Awake

Ingredients

1/2X ✓ 1X 2X

? Original recipe (1X) yields 4 servings

¾ cup white sugar, or to taste

⅓ cup unsweetened cocoa powder

1 pinch salt

⅓ cup boiling water

3 ½ cups milk 

¾ teaspoon vanilla extract

½ cup half-and-half cream

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Directions

Step 1

Gather the ingredients.



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Credit: Dotdash Meredith Food Studios

Step 2

Combine sugar, cocoa powder, and salt in a saucepan; add boiling water and whisk until smooth. Bring mixture to a simmer, stirring continuously to prevent scorching, and cook until slightly thickened, about 2 minutes.



Credit: Allrecipes/Preethi Venkatram

Step 3

Stir in milk and heat until very hot without boiling.



Credit: Allrecipes/Preethi Venkatram

Step 4

Remove from heat; add vanilla.

an into view of a small sauce pan of chocolate and milk, off the heat, with vanilla being added in.

Credit: Allrecipes/Preethi Venkatram

Step 5

Add cream to each mug to help cool cocoa to drinking temperature, then divide hot cocoa between 4 mugs.



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Credit: Allrecipes/Preethi Venkatram

Step 6

Serve hot and enjoy!

 a high angle view on three clear mugs of creamy homemade hot cocoa each topped with mini marshmallows.

Credit: DOTDASH MEREDITH FOOD STUDIOS

**Cook's Note**

Serve with a dusting of cocoa powder or fun toppings like candy canes or colored mini marshmallows for the holidays.

Add a splash of Baileys or peppermint schnapps for an adult twist.

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Nutrition Facts (per serving)

310	9g	53g	9g
Calories	Fat	Carbs	Protein

[Show Full Nutrition Label](#)

Ask the Community (5)

Asked by Janel

How can you store some if you want to make extra?

 [View Answers \(4\)](#)

Asked by Nicholas

What do you reccomend to use INSTEAD of half and half? My country does not sell it.

 [View Answers \(1\)](#)

Asked by KYactor

If I add peppermint extract, how much should I use?

 [View Answers \(1\)](#)

Asked by Janel

How can you store some if you want to make extra?

 [View Answers \(1\)](#)

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My Rating



My Review

What did you think about this recipe? Did you make any changes or notes?

CANCEL

SUBMIT

★★★★☆ 4.7 out of 5

1519 Ratings

<u>5 star</u> ★	1134
<u>4 star</u> ★	308
<u>3 star</u> ★	72
<u>2 star</u> ★	5
<u>1 star</u> ★	0

2,508 home cooks made it!

Most helpful positive review



GRAMSON

★★★★★ 10/27/2005

This is sooo good! I, too, only added 1/2 c sugar. I never use half and half so I decided to use evaporated milk instead. I didn't want to waste the other 8 oz of evap milk so I just poured the 12 oz can into a 4 c measure and then filled with milk and heated it all. I didn't bother with adding sor [Read More](#)

859 Reply

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Aida E

★★★★★ 02/15/2020

I've been trying to replicate the hot chocolate in Italy which was thick and super delicious. While this wasn't as thick, the flavor was excellent. For 2 s [Read More](#)



Rachael

★★★★★

Excellent hot This ad will end in 11 other reviews serving only r styrofoam cup size. I just used [Read More](#)

**kitkatagogo**

★★★★★ 03/17/2026

✔ A keeper! ✔ Great flavors ✔ Easy to follow

Used 1/2 C sugar and it was still a bit too sweet for my tastes. Easily modified. Other than that, I thought it was perfect!

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**mnm9206**

★★★★★ 01/27/2026

✔ A keeper!

Perfect!!

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**Kelli Culpepper**

★★★★★ 12/29/2025

✔ A keeper! ✔ Great flavors ✔ Easy to follow ✔ Worth the effort ✔ Family favorite
✔ Crowd-pleaser

Delicious!!! Did read the comments and used Irish Creme instead of half and half.

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**Kam J**

★★★★★ 12/21/2025

✔ A keeper! ✔ Easy to follow ✔ Great flavors

Delicious! Took the advice of some reviews and did decreased the sugar from 3/4 cup to 1/2 cup, plenty of sweetness with reduced sugar. I did use a milk chocolate stirring spoon so that I added extra chocolate throughout my drinking adventure very yummy. I will have to try this recipe out on the family I think it's a winner :)

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**BriefStraw4897**

★★★★★ 12/10/2025

✔ Easy to follow

Loved

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**Erik Host-Steen**

★★★★★ 12/04/2025

✔ A keeper!

Used a half cup of sugar



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Second go around I did 3 cups of milk and one cup of eggnog instead of cream, along with four cloves soaking in the eggnog for the entire cooking time. Came out great I do think I'll add more salt next time

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**Michael**

★★★★★ 12/02/2025

This is exactly the hot chocolate recipe that I want. It is an American version of hot chocolate. It is not thick, it's more drinkable, especially if using 2% milk. The half-and-half is optional to cut the heat and add a little bit of creaminess. You could also use whipping cream.

👍 0 ↩ Reply

**karen**

★★★★★ 11/30/2025

✓ A keeper! ✓ Easy to follow ✓ Crowd-pleaser ✓ Family favorite

I've made this at least 5 times now and it never disappoints! It is so creamy and delicious. It's definitely my go-to hot chocolate recipe now. I do cut back a bit on the sugar but other than that I don't change anything :)

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Creamy Chocolate Frosting

Creamy Hot Chocolate

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★★★★☆ 30 Ratings

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HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Creamy Vegan Hot Cocoa

★★★★☆ 32 Ratings

close up view

♥

HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Easy Mexican Hot Chocolate

★★★★☆ 143 Ratings

♥

HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Delicious Vegan Hot Chocolate

★★★★☆ 93 Ratings

♥

HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Smooth Hot Chocolate

★★★★☆ 2 Ratings

♥

HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Rich Spiced Hot Chocolate

★★★☆☆ 2 Ratings

♥

HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Mocha Coffee Mix

★★★★☆ 52 Ratings

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HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES

Mocha au Lait Mix

★★★★☆ 30 Ratings



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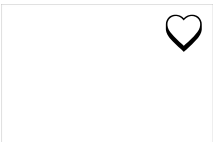
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or a couple of steam
mugs filled with
creamy hot cocoa

★★★★☆ 86 Ratings



HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Maple Syrup Hot Chocolate
★★★★☆ 6 Ratings



HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Thin Mint Cocoa
★★★★☆ 17 Ratings

 A tray with two
mugs of white hot
chocolate, topped
with whipped cream

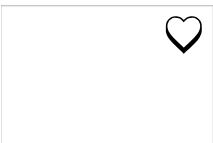


HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Homemade White Hot Chocolate
★★★★☆ 10 Ratings

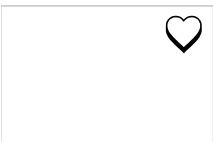
 Champurrado



HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Champurrado (Mexican Hot Chocolate)
★★★★☆ 25 Ratings



HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Dark Chocolate Hot Cocoa
★★★★☆ 18 Ratings



HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Dairy-Free Almond Joy® Hot Chocolate
★★★★☆ 5 Ratings

 Peppermint White
Hot Chocolate



HOT CHOCOLATE RECIPES
Peppermint White Hot Chocolate
★★★★☆ 3 Ratings



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